SpeedUP

English Course

Words for Suggestions and Advice

Suggest
Sugerir

Example Sentence

I **suggest** that you try the new restaurant downtown.

Recommend

Recomendar

Recommend
Recomendar

My doctor **recommends** walking 30 minutes daily.

Advice
Conselho (noun)

Can you give me some **advice** about learning English?

Opinion
Opinião

In my **opinion**, you should take a break.

Idea
Ideia

I have **an idea**! Why don't we go together?

Note: 'Advice' is uncountable → 'some advice' / 'a piece of advice' ✅ ~'an advice' ❌

Suggestions and Advice (part 2)

Usage Tip: ‘Better’ in ‘had better’ means **urgency** or **warning**!

Should
Deveria

You **should** drink more water.

Ought to
Deveria (formal)

We **ought to** help our neighbors.

Had better
Melhor

You’d **better** hurry or you’ll be late!

Propose
Propor

I **propose** that we meet at 3 PM.

Could
Poderia

You **could** ask your teacher for help.

Modal Verbs for Advice 💡

Should

Strength: Advice (strong)

Structure: should + base verb

Example: You should see a doctor.

Forms:

✅ Affirmative: You should rest.

❌ Negative: You shouldn't eat too much sugar.

❓ Question: Should I call her?

Ought to

Strength: Advice (formal)

Structure: ought to + base verb

Example: He ought to apologize.

Could

Strength: Suggestion (gentle)

Structure: could + base verb

Example: You could try meditation.

Modal Verb - Had Better ⚠️

Had Better

Meaning: Strong Advice with Warning/Urgency

Structure: Subject + had better (or 'd better) + base verb

Examples:

📚 - You had better study for the exam, or you'll fail.
🕔 - We'd better leave now, or we'll miss the train. 👨‍⚕️ - She had better not be late again!

Important Differences:

Expression	Meaning
✅ You should go.	Good advice (friendly) ✅
⚠️ You had better go. ⚠️	Strong advice (there will be consequences if you don't!)

Making Suggestions

Why don't you...? / How about...? / What if...?

Why don't you...?

Structure: Why don't you + base verb
Example: Why don't you join a gym?
Practice:
I'm bored. → Why don't you read a book?

How about...?

Structure: How about + gerund (-ing) / noun
Example: How about going to the movies?
Practice:
I need exercise. → How about going for a run?

What if...?

Structure: What if + subject + verb
Example: What if we start a study group?
Practice:
We want to save money. → What if we cook at home?

Giving Strong Advice 🎯

“If I were you, I would...”

Structure: If I were you, I would + base verb

This is the second conditional used for giving advice.

Examples: – If I were you, I would apologize immediately. – If I were you, I wouldn’t worry so much. – If I were you, I’d take that job opportunity.

Why “were” and not “was”? 💡
This is the subjunctive mood for hypothetical situations. Both are used, but “were” is more grammatically correct.

Alternative: - If I were in your position, I would accept the offer. - If I were in your shoes, I’d talk to him honestly.

If I were you, I would...

Examples:

💭 - If I were you, I would apologize immediately.

🤕 - If I were you, I wouldn’t worry so much.

💼 - If I were you, I’d take that job opportunity.